NYC events, *sifted* just for you.

A taste-first event app for young New Yorkers — curated, swipeable, and gets sharper every weekend.

THE SIFT TEAM · SPRING 2026 · SEED LEAVE-BEHIND

01 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Sift is a taste-first event app for young NYC. Already shipping, already learning.

THE PROBLEM

Discovery is broken in NYC.

87% of 18–35 New Yorkers use 3+ apps to find things to do. Across 20 user interviews, the recurring theme: **"I don't want another social media app — I just want to know what's good this weekend."**

OUR SOLUTION

A taste graph for events.

Sift curates with AI + an editor (rejects 85% of incoming inventory), users swipe one card at a time, and the deck re-ranks in real time. Not a feed. Not a follow graph. **Taste, swipe, plan.**

WHERE WE ARE

Live, in production, today.

120+ hand-qualified NYC events, refreshed weekly from 6 tastemaker sources. **23 real users** swiping daily — friends-of-friends, organic, zero spend. Built in 6 weeks.

THE ASK

$750K SAFE · 18 months.

Funds iOS & Android launch, push-notification engine, Sift Pro tier, and curator/creator partnerships. NYC end-to-end before any second city. **$345M ARR opportunity in NYC alone.**

Sift

02 · THE CHANGE

TODAY

You open *six apps* and stay home.

TOMORROW

You open Sift and *your night plans itself.*

NYC's event industry is enormous and the discovery problem is unsolved. The first taste graph for events wins the city — and the category.

03 · THE PROBLEM

NYC has infinite events. None of them feel like you. And nobody wants another feed.

> *"We spend most of our time looking into activities that we end up not even going to. We just get overwhelmed and give up."*
>
> — Sam, 23. One of 20 user interviews.

> *"Honestly? I don't want another social media app. I just want to know what's good this weekend."*
>
> — Recurring theme across 20 interviews. Nobody asked for a feed, a follow graph, or another inbox.

87%

use 3+ apps to find things to do *(Eventbrite + TimeOut + IG + Resy + ...)*

#1

complaint heard: *"too many options, not enough good ones."*

0

interview subjects asked for *another social feed* — they want answers, not another timeline.

04 · WHY NOW

The conditions for a taste graph just landed. The window is open today.

Three shifts converge in 2026. None of them existed five years ago — and the incumbents haven't responded.

AI curation got cheap

An LLM rubric that scores 1,000 events for audience fit costs <$5/wk. The same job needed a five-person editorial team in 2020. We have it running today.

Taste graphs went mainstream

Beli (restaurants), TikTok (video), and Spotify (music) trained a generation to swipe-rate-share. Users now *expect* recs to learn from them. Events haven't caught up.

Aggregators are stale

Eventbrite hasn't shipped a meaningful UX change in 5 years. Editorial sites still publish by hand. None personalize. The window is open *now*.

05 · THE SOLUTION

Sift curates. You swipe. It learns. Not a feed, not a follow graph.

Three behaviors, one app. A taste-maker built and tuned for you — one swipe at a time. Zero social pressure, zero infinite scroll.

1

Discover

One curated card at a time. Right = going. Left = pass. No infinite feed, no FOMO doom-scroll, no "follow your friends to see what they did."

2

Learn

Every swipe, save, and "more like this" tunes the deck instantly. No nightly batch, no cold-start wait. The model is the moat.

3

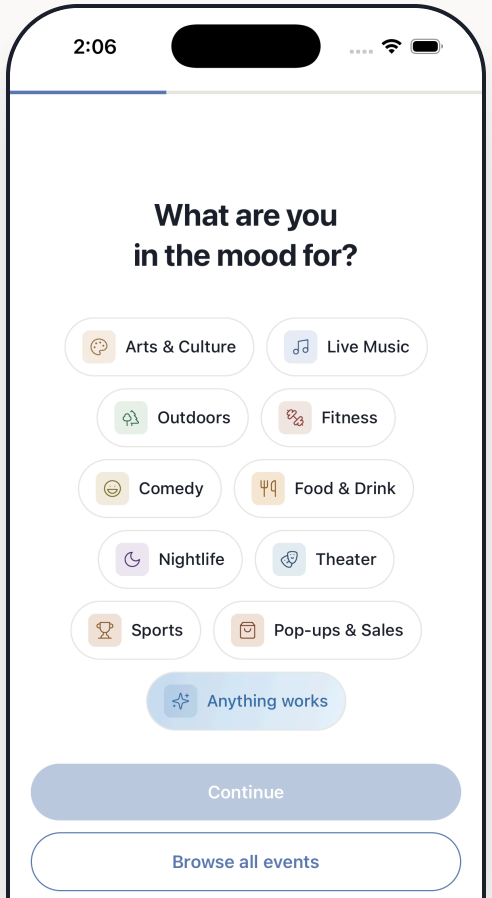
Plan

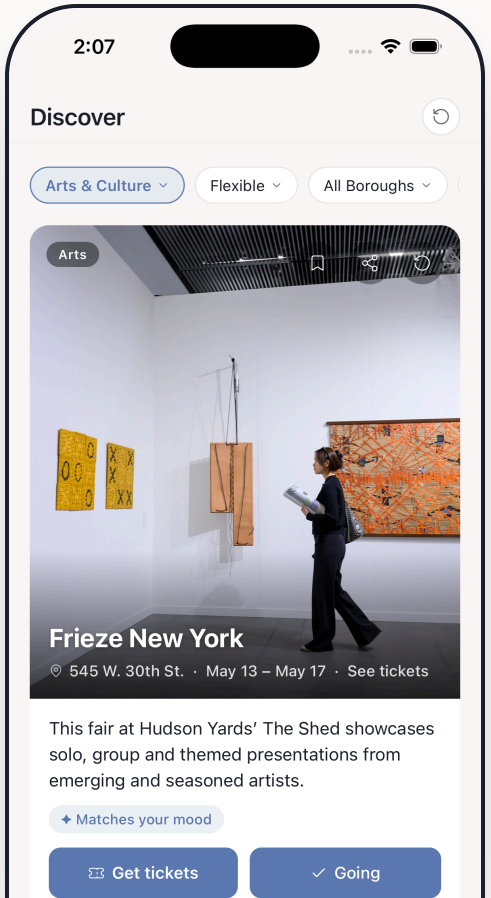
Save, sequence the night, one tap to Apple Calendar with the venue address. From swipe to "added to my Saturday" in <30 seconds.

Sift

06 · INSIDE THE APP

Open it. Tell it your vibe. Swipe. Three screens, three taps.





07 · THE PRODUCT — THIS ISN'T A MOCK

Real catalog. Real users. Real swipes. Already in production.

120+

hand-qualified NYC events live in production right now — refreshed weekly.

85%

of ingested events *rejected* by our AI rubric + human review.

6

tastemaker sources — Ticketmaster, Eater, Infatuation, TimeOut, Resy Hit List, Dice.

23

real users with real taste profiles — swiping right now, not a waitlist.

*The hard part — **a curated NYC catalog** — already exists. The taste loop on top of it is what scales the rest of the city.*

08 · HOW THE TASTE GRAPH WORKS

Curate hard. Score every signal. Re-rank in real time. The model compounds.

Step 1 · Curate

Reject 85% before it touches a user.

- AI ingest from 6 tastemaker sources *(Ticketmaster, Eater, Infatuation, TimeOut, Resy, Dice)*
- LLM rubric scores audience fit, venue quality, verified dates, real prices
- Human editor reviews keep-pile weekly — no fabricated listings
- *Eventbrite structurally can't do this — their model needs the firehose.*

Step 2 · Signal

Three signals, three weights.

- **Swipe** — soft signal. Right boosts category, left dampens.
- **Feedback sheet** — explicit "more / less like this" retunes a whole vibe.
- **Save / Going** — beacon. Similar events climb the deck immediately.
- No nightly batch. No cold-start wait. Re-rank in <200ms.

Step 3 · Compound

The model is the moat.

- ~20 swipes warms a profile — one session.
- Every swipe across every user makes the next swipe smarter.
- City-agnostic: same rubric, swap the editorial lead, repeat.
- By month 6 the taste graph is the asset — not the catalog.

09 · COMPETITION & STATUS QUO

Volume vs. editorial vs. taste. Sift is the only taste play — and the only one with a learning loop.

	EVENTBRITE / DICE	TIMEOUT / INFATUATION	GROUP CHAT *(status quo)*	SIFT
Curated	× firehose	✓ **static**	✓ **by friends**	✓ **AI + editor**
Personalized	×	×	×	✓ **real-time**
One-tap to plan	×	×	× texts	✓ **calendar export**
Why we win	*Their model needs the firehose*	*Editorial can't scale to 1:1*	*Doesn't fix "what to do?"*	**Reject 85%. Re-rank in real time.**

10 · TRACTION — THE SLOPE

Zero to live app, full taste loop, 23 real users — in six weeks.

WEEK 1–2

Catalog pipeline

AI ingest from 6 sources, dedupe, scoring rubric, human review queue. 0 → 120 events.

WEEK 3–4

Swipe + taste model

Real-time re-rank, explicit feedback sheet, undo. The aha-loop in production.

WEEK 5

Plan + calendar

Going/saved sync, day-by-day plan, one-tap iOS calendar with venue address.

WEEK 6 — NOW

23 real users

Friends-of-friends, organic, zero spend. Onboarding polish + push notifications next.

11 · BUSINESS MODEL

Three revenue lanes. The taste-data asset sits underneath all three.

NEAR-TERM

Booking referrals

Resy, Ticketmaster, Dice affiliate fees on tickets and reservations. 5–15% per booking, zero ad inventory required, paid only on conversion.

MID-TERM

Curator placement

Eater, Infatuation, top NYC creators run their own Sift lists. Brands and venues pay for placement inside curated decks. Native, not banner.

LONG-TERM

Sift Pro

Free: 10 daily picks. Pro at $9/mo: unlimited deck, early access to drops, exclusive curator lists, priority booking. Margin lane, not volume.

12 · MARKET SIZE — BOTTOM-UP, NYC ONLY

$345M ARR in NYC alone. The same playbook unlocks every other major city.

STEP 1	NYC residents aged 18–35 *(US Census, 2023)*	3.0M
STEP 2	× 50% in our target band *(active social spenders, post-college)*	1.5M
STEP 3	× 30% reachable in 5 yrs *(reasonable share of category)*	450K
STEP 4	× $200/wk going-out spend *(survey + Beli/Resy benchmarks)*	$4.7B GMV
SOM	× ~7% blended take *(referrals + sponsored + Pro)* = **annual revenue, NYC**	$345M

13 · GO-TO-MARKET

Three phases. Each one earns the right to the next. CAC stays under $8 through phase 2.

PHASE 1 · NOW → Q3 2026

NYC core

- Friends-of-friends + creator seeding (Tier-2 NYC TikTok)
- Curator partnerships — Eater + Infatuation lists inside the app
- Referral loop: invite a friend, both unlock a list
- Press: NY Mag, The Cut, Brooklyn Mag launch coverage

Target: **10K MAU, 30% W4 retention, <$3 CAC.**

PHASE 2 · Q4 2026 → Q1 2027

NYC scale + revenue

- Push-notification engine — weekend pickups + drop alerts
- Paid social on validated creator content (LTV/CAC > 3)
- Booking-referral revenue turns on (Resy + Ticketmaster live)
- Sift Pro tier in paid beta with NYC power users

Target: **75K MAU NYC, 30% W4 retention, $40K MRR.**

PHASE 3 · 2027+

Own NYC, then second city

- Pro tier scales — $9/mo, target 5% paid conversion
- NYC fully owned: 250K MAU, deep editorial moat
- Second-city playbook scoped *only after NYC unit economics prove*
- Taste-graph API conversations with venues + ticketers

Target: **NYC dominance · $4M ARR run-rate.**

14 · 18-MONTH ROADMAP

Quarter-by-quarter plan. Funded entirely by this round.

Q2 2026 · NOW

Polish & pipeline

- → Onboarding polish + share loops
- → Push-notification engine v1
- → Automated weekly catalog refresh
- → 23 → 1K NYC users

Q3 2026

Android & revenue

- → Android app launch
- → Resy + Ticketmaster booking referrals live
- → Hire NYC editorial + growth lead
- → 1K → 10K NYC users

Q4 2026

NYC depth + Pro

- → Sift Pro tier in beta with paid users
- → First sponsored curator placements
- → Booking-referral revenue compounding
- → 75K MAU NYC, $40K MRR

Q1–Q2 2027

Own NYC + Series A

- → NYC editorial moat — Eater + Infatuation native
- → Pro at 5% paid conversion
- → $4M ARR run-rate, A-ready metrics
- → Series A target: $5–8M to fund the second city

15 · RISKS & MITIGATIONS

What could break this — and exactly what we do about it.

RISK 01 · DISTRIBUTION

Cold-start beyond friends-of-friends.

Every event app that's tried social has died bootstrapping the network. Paid acquisition without payback kills runway.

MITIGATION

Creator + curator seeding, not paid social.

Eater and Infatuation curate inside the app — their audience is already ours. Referral unlocks lists. Paid social only after LTV/CAC > 3 on validated creator content.

RISK 02 · CATALOG SCALING

Hand-curation doesn't scale to 5 cities.

The 85% reject rate depends on a human reviewer. Hiring 5 editorial leads is slow and expensive.

MITIGATION

One editorial lead per city — same playbook.

The AI rubric does 90% of the cut; the human reviews the keep-pile (~30 min/wk). One lead per city is the model. City-agnostic rubric is the moat.

RISK 03 · INCUMBENT RESPONSE

Eventbrite or TikTok ships a "for you" feed.

If a giant copies the loop, our window closes.

MITIGATION

Their model can't reject the firehose.

Eventbrite's economics need 100% inventory live. TikTok ranks creators, not events. The taste graph compounds — by month 6 the model is the moat, not the catalog.

16 · TEAM

Builders who live the problem. Target demographic, in the product daily.

Built solo so far — full-stack mobile, AI ingest pipeline, and editorial system. This round buys focused product velocity: iOS & Android launch, push notifications, Sift Pro, and the curator/creator partnerships that drive growth.

Yi-Jie Cheng

Jary Tolentino

Irene Nam

Jerry Anthony Gu

17 · USE OF FUNDS

$750K SAFE. 18 months runway. Every dollar is line-itemed.

40%	**Engineering + product** — iOS & Android launch, push-notification engine, automated ingest, Sift Pro infra.	$300K
30%	**Catalog + curation** — content licensing, weekly curator stipends, editorial review tooling.	$225K
20%	**Marketing + growth** — creator seeding, app-store assets, referral mechanics. *No paid social until LTV/CAC > 3.*	$150K
10%	**Operations** — legal, infra, accounting, contractor coverage.	$75K

What this round buys

- ✓ NYC: 23 → 75K MAU
- ✓ iOS & Android live
- ✓ Booking-referral revenue compounding
- ✓ Sift Pro in paid beta
- ✓ $40K MRR run-rate
- ✓ A-round-ready metrics by Q2 2027

$750K to make NYC *unmissable.*

$750K SAFE · 18 months runway · funds iOS & Android launch, push-notification engine, Sift Pro tier, and owning NYC end-to-end before any second city.

NYC's event industry is enormous and the discovery problem is unsolved. Sift makes sure you actually go to the right ones — and is the first taste graph for events.

THANK YOU · QUESTIONS?